

Outdoor Equipment & Outdoor Learning Area Risk Assessment

Equipment Name	Hazards	Risk	Likelihood	Consequences	Risk Rating	Controls	Procedure
Front Gates – EYLC wooden entry gate & preschool verandah entry gate	1. Child climbing over the gate.	Lost Child	Possible	Catastrophic	Extreme	• Direct supervision of the gate at all times when children are outside.	• Staff member positioned next or close to gate
	2. Child opening the gate					• Direct supervision of the gate at all times when children are outside. • Head counts conducted at regular intervals throughout the day • Latch on the gate is above reach of children. • Latches are checked each morning for sound latching mechanism Check • chain is in good condition and attachment bolts are secure	Staff member positioned next to the gate Morning outdoor check • Equipment Policy • Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy
	3. Fingers/ hands caught in the gate	Finger Entrapment	Possible	Moderate	High	• Educators directly supervise the gate area at high usage times when children are in the outdoor learning environment.	• Children are directed away from the gate area when playing. Children greeting/ farewell families are directly supervised
	4. Gate left open/unlatched	Children can move into unsupervised front garden area	Possible	Moderate	High	• Signs on the gates instructing visitors/families/ staff to close the gates • Ensure self-closing hinges on the gates are in working order	• Morning outdoor check • Equipment Policy

		and possibly off the service's grounds					• Ensure gate area is supervised when children are outside and playing in that area. • Lock on the side gate is latched at all times	• Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy • Relationships with children policy • Morning outdoor check
Bike Track	5. Dry wood	Splinter, grazes, cuts.	Possible	Minor	Moderate		• Check wooden boards for splinters, oil if required to reduce splinters	• Morning outdoor check • Equipment Policy • Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy • Staffing Arrangements Policy • Bike Safety policy
		Bruising	Possible	Minor	Moderate		• Insure that the bike track area is supervised when children are outside • Insure the area is clear of debris • Insure safety rules for using the track are being followed.	
		Cuts & abrasions	Unlikely	Minor	Low			
		Sprains or Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Low			
		Head injury from falls	Rare	Catastrophic	High			
The Fort & Log Pile	1. Child falling and landing: • Awkwardly on soft fall. • on another child	Bruising	Possible	Minor	Moderate		• Check safety of equipment each morning including Netting, slide, rope and splintering wood.	• Morning outdoor check • Equipment Policy
		Cuts & abrasions	Unlikely	Minor	Low			
		Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Moderate			

	on a piece of equipment	Spinal injury	Rare	Catastrophic	High	- Insure area around the fort is clear of sticks, branches, toys and other climbing equipment for a distance of 1m. - Insure that the soft fall area is supervised when children are outside and playing in that area.	- Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy
The suspended Stepping stones & Tight walk rope	Child: - Splinters from timbers - Chain breaking or becoming unattached from top timber. Child falling and landing: - Awkwardly on soft fall.	Bruising	Possible	Minor	Moderate	Check chain is in good condition and attachment bolts are secure	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy
		Cuts & abrasions	Unlikely	Minor	Low		
		Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Moderate		
The Mud Kitchen	- Water pooling in buckets. - Insects, snakes, mosquitoes. - Children climbing on benches.	Drowning	Rare	Catastrophic	High	- Inspect area each morning for spider, snakes, insects, etc. - Empty buckets after rain or activities involving water. - Supervision when children are playing in area	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy
		Digestion of unclean water	Rare	Moderate	Low		
		Dirt in eyes	Unlikely	Moderate	Moderate		
		Fall	Unlikely	Minor	Low		

		Bites from snakes	Rare	Major	Moderate		
Obstacle course climbing equipment on soft fall	1. Child falling and landing: - Awkwardly on soft fall. - on another child - on a piece of equipment 2. Equipment falling over	Bruising	Possible	Minor	Moderate	- Check safety of equipment each morning - Insure that the soft fall area is supervised when children are outside and playing in that area. - Check wooden boards for splinters, oil annually or more regularly if required. - Insure plastic ends are on metal equipment. - Insure setup of equipment is set on softfall if above 50cm high.	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy
		Cuts & abrasions	Unlikely	Minor	Low		
		Sprains or Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Moderate		
		Spinal injury	Rare	Catastrophic	High		
Creek Bed	- Falls on uneven rocks - Rocks thrown or dropped. - Water pooling in creek beds	Bruising	Possible	Minor	Moderate	- Inspect area in the morning - Insure good supervision while children are outside - Discourage children from lifting rocks or removing them from the area. - If children are pooling water insure good supervision and drain water when activity is completed.	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy
		Sprains or Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Moderate		
		Drowning	Rare	Catastrophic	High		

Water Tank	Children climbing on top and falling off	Bruising and abrasions	Likely	Minor	Moderate	- Supervision of children. Educate the children that it is not for climbing - Insure manhole is covered with strainer. - Keep gutter clean - Inspection of inside of tank regularly.	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy
	Children removing the manhole cover and falling in.	Sprains or Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Moderate		
		Drowning	Rare	Catastrophic	High		
Water Pump	Drowning from water pooled in creek, collect in buckets or containers.	Drowning	Rare	Catastrophic	High	- Supervision of children. - Encourage child to stand on wooden platform when pumping water and not under the spout. - Do not let the children drink the water.	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy
	Cleanness of water	Digestion of unclean water	Rare	Moderate	Low		
	Entrapment of finger/s hand from pump handle	Bruising and abrasions	Rare	Moderate	Low		
Sandpit		Loose of finger	Rare	Major	Moderate		
	Animal faeces in sandpit	Poor hygiene and diseases and/or infection from animal faeces	Unlikely	Moderate	Moderate	- Sandpit is covered when yard not in use - Sandpit is raked weekly - Daily outdoor check - Supervision of children	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy
	Children throwing sand	Sand in eyes	Likely	Minor	Moderate		
	Children falling off bridge		Possible	Minor	Moderate		

		Falling awkwardly or landing n equipment or another child							
Sheds and storage areas	- Equipment falling off shelves - Children not supervised - Shed closed while children are inside shed	Injury from equipment falling off shelves. Children locked in shed if staff unaware that a child has entered the shed	Unlikely	Minor	Low	- Signage showing children not allowed in sheds. - Supervision of children - Keep shed tidy and well organised - Where possible keep sheds closed and locked when not in use.	- Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy		
Poles & Mulch in Loose Part Areas	- Animal faeces in bark softfall - Children falling off poles ropes or loose parts equipment	Poor hygiene and diseases and/or infection from animal faeces	Unlikely	Moderate	Moderate	- Mulch is raked weekly to check for foreign object and to air rate it. - Daily outdoor check - Supervision of children - Discussion of risks with children - Educators are knowledge of children skills and monitor risks with design and construction changes.	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy		
		Bruising	Possible	Minor	Moderate				
		Cuts & abrasions	Unlikely	Minor	Low				
		Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Moderate				
	Spinal injury	Rare	Catastrophic	High					
Choking hazards by ropes	Bruising, rope burn, choking	Rare	Catastrophic	High					
Disability Ramp	- Climbing on rails - Hot pathway	Falling onto ramp or mulch area causing bruising to broken bones	Possible	Minor	Moderate	- Supervision of area. - Discouraging children from play on ramp. - Signage to warn families/visitors of hot ramp. - Encourage children to wear shoes when using the ramp during summer & days were	- Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy		
		Blisters to burn on soles of feet	Possible	Minor	Moderate				

	• Children leaving the grounds	Children not in a safe supervised area.	Unlikely	Moderate	Moderate	• Insure staff are aware of supervision responsibilities. When staff numbers are low only use one yard area and/or encourage children to use one area of yard. • Staff aware of blind spots and areas where fence is lower or easier to climb. • Check gates are locked. • Avoid setting up equipment close to fence where it can be used as a tool to aid climbing over fences. • Annual pest inspection & spraying • Supervision of children especially children under 3 years of age. • Knowledge of children behaviours (those who are more likely to put objects in their mouths)	• Relationships with Children Policy
	• Spiders living in gardens, logs, fencing, toys and fixed structures	Bites from spiders	Possible	Moderate	Moderate		
	• Foreign objects placed in mouths	Choking Digestion of none food item	Possible	Moderate	Moderate		

Review

The Management, employees, families and interested parties will monitor and review the effectiveness of this policy annually or more regularly if required or when structural changes are made to the outdoor areas.

- Reviewed by: Elizabeth Price Position: Nominated Supervisor
Date: 07/06/2023 Signature: 
- Accepted by Committee Member: Position: COMMITTEE
Name: SUE RAY Signature: 
- Previously reviewed: 5/06/2022 Date for next review: 07/06/2024

Date: 18.6.23

CC		What would be the consequence of this emergency					Catastrophic	
What is the likelihood that this emergency will occur?	Almost certain						Extreme	Extreme
	Likely						Extreme	Extreme
	Possible						High	Extreme
	Unlikely						High	High
	Rare						Moderate	High

